

Kate Prior (nee Loesel)
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May 22, 2026
Search Committee
School of Humanities and Social Sciences
Valencia College

Dear Members of the Search Committee,

I am writing to express my enthusiastic interest in the Part-Time Faculty, Humanities position in the School of Humanities and Social Sciences at Valencia College. As a doctoral candidate in Texts and Technology at the University of Central Florida, I bring a strong interdisciplinary foundation in humanities scholarship, a demonstrated commitment to student-centered pedagogy, and practical experience designing and implementing inclusive, outcomes-driven courses across multiple modalities. I am excited by Valencia's mission to advance student learning and achievement, and I believe my scholarly background and teaching philosophy align closely with the values your school fosters.

My academic preparation equips me well for the HUM1020, HUM2210, HUM2230, and HUM2250 course sequence. I hold a Master of Arts in Film Theory and Criticism from Central Michigan University, where I developed deep expertise in humanistic inquiry, cultural analysis, and the intersections of literature, media, and philosophy that are central to general humanities education. My ongoing doctoral work in Texts and Technology further expands this foundation, integrating digital humanities methods with cultural and media studies. This allows me to draw genuine connections across art history, philosophy, religion, literature, and music, helping students see how these fields speak to each other and to the broader human experience.

My teaching record reflects a consistent commitment to learning-centered practice. As an Instructor of Record for eight semesters in UCF's Department of English and in Games and Interactive Media, I have designed and taught courses including DIG3024 Digital Cultures and Narratives and ENC4415 Digital Rhetorics and the Modern Dialectic, courses that require exactly the kind of integrative humanistic thinking I would bring to Valencia's humanities curriculum. I have taught in face-to-face, hybrid, and online formats, and I am well-versed in leveraging learning management systems and emerging technologies to enhance student engagement. Earlier this year, I was honored with UCF's Excellence in

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Graduate Student Teaching Award from the College of Arts and Humanities, a recognition that reflects my dedication to meaningful, rigorous instruction.

I design my courses around diverse learning strategies that meet students where they are. I draw on formative and summative assessments to monitor and support student progress, and I intentionally build inclusion into curriculum design, ensuring that student diversity enriches rather than merely coexists within the learning environment. I am familiar with competency-based learning frameworks and am committed to the kind of developmental advising philosophy that Valencia's LifeMap program represents: understanding students as whole people with evolving academic and life goals. My scholarship, including a peer-reviewed publication in *Transformative Works and Cultures* and presentations at international conferences, keeps me current in my discipline and informs a pedagogy grounded in the scholarship of teaching and learning.

I am a Florida resident and fully prepared to meet the requirements of this position, including face-to-face and mixed-mode teaching modalities. I would welcome the opportunity to contribute to the intellectual community at Valencia College and to support students in developing the critical thinking and communication skills that a humanities education uniquely provides.

Thank you for your consideration.

Sincerely,

Kate Prior